

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1043

By Sexton

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend comedian and Old Hickory native Nate Bargatze.

WHEREAS, it is the privilege of the members of this General Assembly to recognize those outstanding Tennesseans whose natural talent and devotion to their craft have vaulted them to the very pinnacle of success; and

WHEREAS, hailed as "The Nicest Man in Stand-Up" by *The Atlantic*, Nate Bargatze has become a household name in recent years, with his trademark everyman, family-friendly standup routines, at once relatable and hilarious, being streamed for over sixty-two million hours globally across multiple platforms; and

WHEREAS, his first solo one-hour Netflix special, *The Tennessee Kid*, premiered in 2019 to rave reviews, and his 2021 follow-up Netflix special, *The Greatest Average American*, received critical acclaim and a Grammy nomination for Best Comedy Album; his third one-hour special, *Hello World*, premiered on Amazon Prime in 2023 and holds the record as the outlet's most-streamed original comedy special in its first twenty-eight days of viewership; and

WHEREAS, in 2024, Mr. Bargatze returned to Netflix with a two stand-up special deal, the first of which, *Your Friend, Nate Bargatze*, premiered on December 24, 2024, and landed in the Top 10 most-watched shows globally for two weeks; in the spring of 2025, it was the most watched standup special on Netflix in the past fifty-two weeks, with his two previous Netflix specials listed at No. 16 and No. 14 on the fifty-two-week chart, even though they premiered six and four years earlier, respectively; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bargatze is currently the top-earning comedian in the world according to Pollstar's recent report and twelfth in overall live-tour ticket sales, putting him in the company of

Coldplay, Madonna, and U2. *Billboard* recently announced that Bargatze set a new record for the biggest one-year gross by a comedy performer in history; and

WHEREAS, in 2023, Bargatze unveiled Nateland Entertainment, a family-friendly content company through which he produces standup comedy specials, showcases, sketches, and scripted episodic content for film, television, podcasts, music, and more; and

WHEREAS, in May 2025, he published his highly anticipated first book, *Big Dumb Eyes: Stories From A Simpler Mind*, which instantly became the *New York Times* No. 1 best-selling book and remained on the best-seller list for eleven weeks; and

WHEREAS, he has also proven himself a compelling host, delivering the opening monologue in Studio 8H with *Saturday Night Live* twice, first in 2023 and again in 2024, each time to rave reviews and enthusiastic reception by audiences; as host of the seventy-seventh Primetime Emmy Awards on CBS in 2024, he drew the show's largest audience in four years; and

WHEREAS, his most recent hosting gig is with *The Greatest Average American*, a trivia show that premiered on February 25, 2026, on ABC and Hulu; co-created and executive produced by Mr. Bargatze and John Quinn (*Price is Right*), the show celebrates the power of being perfectly average and boasts a grand prize of \$67,920—the average American salary; and

WHEREAS, he will also be making his silver-screen debut in 2026 with *The Breadwinner*, a family-friendly comedy with TriStar Pictures that he co-wrote and served as executive producer; the film co-stars Mandy Moore, Colin Jost, Will Forte, and Kumail Nanjiani and is directed by Emmy winner Eric Appel; and

WHEREAS, despite his many ventures, Nate Bargatze continues to wow audiences with his original standup routines—his *Be Funny* tour grossed upwards of \$88 million, making him the top-grossing comedian of 2024; the tour broke ticket and attendance records across the

country, including in his home state, where he became the only comedian ever to sell out three consecutive performances at Bridgestone Arena in Nashville; and

WHEREAS, currently on his 2025 Big Dumb Eyes World Tour, Nate Bargatze continues to break venue attendance and ticket sales records; and

WHEREAS, throughout his meteoric rise, Nate Bargatze, a self-noted native of Old Hickory, has shown that authenticity resonates across geographic and cultural divides and that being average is in itself a quite extraordinary thing; and

WHEREAS, a two-time Grammy- and Emmy-nominated comedian, *New York Times* No. 1 bestselling author, podcaster, director, and producer, Mr. Bargatze has reached heights to which few individuals in comedy have ascended, and fewer still have done so while remaining true to themselves and exhibiting the utmost integrity, humility, and pride in who they are and where they come from; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend comedian Nate Bargatze, a Tennessee kid who made good, and one of whom the Volunteer State is exceedingly proud.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.